

Becker Friedman Institute for Economics (BFI), University of Chicago

The Becker Friedman Institute for Economics (BFI) is the University of Chicago's economic research hub focused on producing data-driven insights that inform policy and public understanding. As part of the University of Chicago Data Science Clinic, this project expands on the paper **100 Years of Rising Corporate Concentration** (Kwon, Ma, Zimmermann, 2024), which studies how corporate concentration in the United States has evolved over the past century across industries and sectors. To broaden the accessibility and public impact of the paper's findings, the BFI partnered with the Data Science Clinic to create an interactive dashboard that visualizes long-run trends in corporate concentration. The project translates complex historical economic datasets into intuitive and interactive visualizations as well as period analysis designed not only for journalists, researchers, policymakers but also for students and the general public. The dashboard and analysis helps users explore how market concentration has changed over time and how these trends differ across industries, sectors, and measures of economic activity.

The team developed an interactive dashboard (as shown in Figure 1a & 1b) and a key period analysis that highlights our findings from the dashboard (as shown Figure 2a & 2b). Together, the page helps highlight specific industry-specific concentrations using historical sector-level data spanning more than 100 years of U.S. economic history. Users can explore concentration trends across major sectors, compare industries over time, and investigate how historical events and economic shifts correspond to changes in market structure. The interactive visualizations, and the key period analysis allow users to identify periods of rapid consolidation, compare long-run sector dynamics, and better understand the economic implications of rising corporate concentration.

Figure 1a. Overview of Concentration by Sector

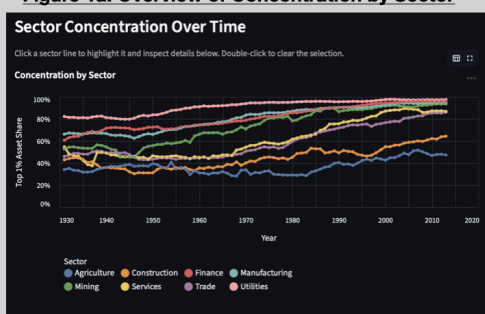


Figure 1b. Sub-sector Analysis

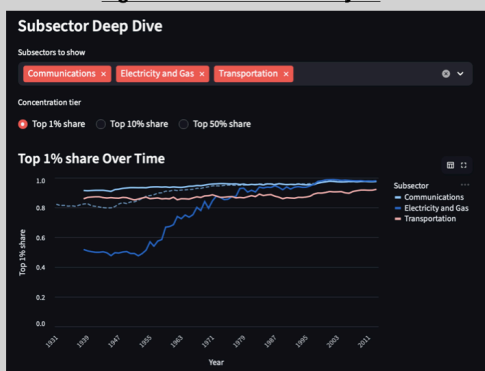


Figure 2a. Key Period Analysis Overview



Figure 2b. Sub-Sector Breakdown w/Analysis

